C1 Vocabulary

# Academic vocabulary for essays

High-value words from academic English that lift the register of your writing.

These words appear frequently in academic texts across all subjects. Swap them in for simpler words to make your essays more precise.

**substantial** adj.

large in amount or importance

*There is substantial evidence for this claim.*

**undermine** verb

to weaken gradually

*Constant criticism can undermine confidence.*

**inherent** adj.

existing as a natural, permanent part

*Every investment carries inherent risk.*

**facilitate** verb

to make a process easier

*Technology can facilitate learning.*

**discrepancy** noun

a difference between things that should match

*There was a discrepancy between the two reports.*

**advocate** verb

to publicly support an idea

*Many experts advocate earlier intervention.*

**plausible** adj.

seeming reasonable or likely

*This is a plausible explanation.*

**mitigate** verb

to make something less harmful

*Measures were taken to mitigate the impact.*

**notion** noun

an idea or belief

*The notion of free will is debated.*

**comprehensive** adj.

including everything necessary

*The report gives a comprehensive overview.*

**subsequently** adv.

after that; later

*The data was subsequently analysed.*

**constrain** verb

to limit or restrict

*Our research was constrained by funding.*

## Practice

1. Replace the simple word: The new road will *make easier* trade between the towns.
2. Replace the simple word: Several studies *support* a four-day week.
3. Replace the simple word: The results *weaken* the original theory.

▼ **Show answers**

1. facilitate
2. advocate

3. undermine